Daily Need to Know

Thursday, 3 September 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — SETTLED AT THE 2 SEPTEMBER CLOSE, 04:00 GMT+8, 5H07M BEFORE CAPTURE			
S&P 500	7,666.60	▲ +0.46%	Range **7633.62–7681.19**; closed in the upper third but **4.4pts below** Hedgeye's 7671 TRADE line. 45.6% of the 7601–7745 band. Volume 100.6% of the 10-day average — a bounce on ordinary participation.
Nasdaq Composite	26,217.83	▲ +0.45%	Snapped a three-day losing streak. Still **−3.58%** from its 52-week high of 27,190.
Dow Jones	53,061.95	▲ +0.56%	Best of the majors on the day. Volume only **90.1%** of average — the thinnest of the three.
Russell 2000	2,953.17	▲ +1.13%	**Day's leader**, and the one index Hedgeye is short. 53.2% of the 2900–3000 band; band shifted down 34–40pts overnight.
Philadelphia SOX	11,339.25	▲ +0.45%	Up on the day but **−22.6% from its 52-week high** of 14,655. The single clearest picture of the bubble deflating.
US INDEX FUTURES — LIVE, GLOBEX FROM 06:00 GMT+8; 3H07M ELAPSED, 1.4–3.1% OF A NORMAL DAY'S VOLUME			
E-mini S&P (ES)	7,673.25	▼ -0.04%	Settled **7676.50**. Basis to cash **+6.65** — normal, confirming the cash settle is a settle. 15,507 lots.
E-mini Nasdaq (NQ)	29,155.50	▼ -0.11%	Settled **29,186.25**. Softest of the four overnight. 14,163 lots.
E-mini Dow (YM)	53,145.00	▲ +0.05%	Only major future **higher** overnight. Basis +83 to cash. 1,085 lots — very thin.
E-mini Russell (RTY)	2,956.80	▼ -0.07%	Settled **2958.80**. Basis +3.63. Giving back a little of the cash session's outperformance.
US TREASURY YIELDS — LIVE CASH MARKET; THE 10-YEAR IS AT A THREE-YEAR HIGH			
US 10-year	4.780%	◆ +0.000%	**Unchanged** at 4.780% — but the session range 4.770–4.784 is live, so this is a genuine flat print, not a stale bar. Printed **4.816%** in this rally, the highest since October 2023. 68.8% of Hedgeye's 4.67–4.83 band.
US 30-year	5.257%	▼ -0.057%	5.257%, within 8bp of its 52-week high. 30s10s **+47.7bp**.
US 5-year	4.537%	▲ +0.022%	4.537% against a 52-week high of 4.575% — the belly is at the top of its year-long range too.
13-week bill	3.879%	▲ +0.388%	3.879%. **No intraday range** — open, high and low are identical, so treat this as a single print. 10Y–3M spread **+90.1bp**.
ENERGY — LIVE FUTURES, THE MACRO VARIABLE OF THE WEEK			
WTI crude (CL1)	$90.82	▼ -0.21%	Settled **$91.01**. **85.5%** of Hedgeye's 83.96–91.98 band, and the whole band shifted **up $1.73–$2.45** in a day. Six-week highs on the Hormuz strikes.
Brent (BZ1)	$95.24	▼ -0.41%	Near **$95**. Rose ~5% Tuesday to its highest since late July.
Natural gas (NG1)	$3.013	▲ +1.93%	**Best performer on the board overnight.** 87.7% of the 2.75–3.05 band; TREND flipped **neutral to bullish**.
RBOB gasoline	$3.0949	▼ -0.29%	Easing slightly against the crude bid — crack is not confirming the move.
METALS — LIVE SPOT, THE SERIES HEDGEYE'S BANDS ACTUALLY NAME			
Gold (spot)	$4,395.21	▲ +0.16%	Back **above** the $4,355 TRADE line that broke Tuesday. 28.8% of the 4251–4752 band — a band that **widened 34%** in a day. Still **−21.5%** from its 52-week high.
Silver (spot)	$65.481	▲ +0.24%	Recovered above the **$65.11** TRADE line McCullough sold into. But TREND was cut **bullish to neutral** and the band dropped $2. **−46.2%** from its 52-week high.
Copper (spot)	$6.4723	▼ -0.07%	32.1% of the 6.36–6.71 band. Measured on futures it would read 68.4% — a **36pp** error. The basis is 1.96%.
FX — LIVE, BUT ONLY 4H07M SINCE THE 05:00 GMT+8 ROLLOVER; RANGES OF 4–26BP MAKE THESE CHANGES NOISE, NOT MOVES			
Dollar index (DXY)	99.549	▼ -0.027%	Session range just **8.8bp**. 63.9% of the 98.77–99.99 band. The dollar is the stated catalyst for gold: Hedgeye puts the inverse trending correlation at **92%**.

USD/JPY	158.624	▼ -0.038%	158.62, within 3.4% of a 52-week high, with JGB yields at 30-year highs. Range 26bp — the widest of the majors, and still tiny.
USD/KRW	1,358.52	▼ -0.074%	1358.52. Won firm as the KOSPI bounces — range 10.6bp.
VOLATILITY AND CRYPTO — CRYPTO IS THE ONLY GENUINELY 24-HOUR ROW HERE			
VIX	15.19	▼ -6.98%	Crushed **−1.14** to 15.19 on the bounce. 29.7% of the 14.43–16.99 band — but that band was marked **up** 40–71bp overnight. Falling spot, rising band.
Bitcoin	$77,191.42	▼ -0.16%	**−38.9%** from its 52-week high of $126,230 — and Hedgeye **added IBIT to the long side** yesterday into exactly that drawdown.

Key: ▲ up · ▼ down · ◆ unchanged. Cash equity rows are settled closes; every other row is a live level captured 09:06:57–09:06:59 GMT+8.

*Reconciliation. All prices from a single TradingView bulk capture, 09:06:57–09:06:59 GMT+8 (2.3s window). Yahoo Finance aborted on a 5-consecutive-429 circuit breaker, so there is no second machine source and **no divergent rows to resolve because no second source ran** — that is not a clean reconciliation, and section 18 says so. The four headline index closes were cross-checked by hand against the Associated Press "How major US stock indexes fared" wire and matched to the decimal on all four. Cash-index arithmetic (close less change equals prior close) is self-consistent to 0.000000% on all six indices tested.*

TL;DR

Equities bounced and the bond market did not. The S&P added 0.46%, the Dow 0.56% and the Russell 1.13%, snapping a three-day losing streak — while the 10-year sat at **4.78%** having printed 4.816%, its highest since October 2023, and fed funds futures moved to a **66% probability that the Fed hikes 25bp on 15–16 September**, up from 35–57% a week ago. Equity investors bought a market that is repricing towards tightening.

Oil is the mechanism, and it is a war story. US forces struck roughly 100 Iranian targets around the Strait of Hormuz and, for the first time, Iranian tankers under a "tanker-for-tanker" policy, after projectiles hit two tankers off Oman on 31 August. Brent is near **$95**, WTI near **$91**. Hedgeye's arithmetic: every **$1** on oil adds roughly **3bp** to their CPI nowcast, taking it from ~3.50% toward ~3.65%.

The number nobody led with is in credit. Investment-grade closed **0.14% above its 52-week low**, high yield 0.69% above, long Treasuries 0.96% above. Equities made a bounce; credit made lows.

Four Hedgeye TREND signals flipped in one session — Nikkei and Shanghai to bearish, silver from bullish to neutral, natural gas to bullish — and the gold band widened 34%. Asia opens into a stagflation regime that Hedgeye has nowcast as Global Quad 3 since Q2.

2 The big picture — what it means

1. **A weak labour print and a rising hike probability are the same story, and that story is stagflation.** ADP said private payrolls grew **38,000** in August against a **48,000** consensus, down from 46,000 in July and the slowest month since January. July non-farm payrolls were outright **negative at −23,000**. On any pre-2026 reaction function that is a cutting cycle. Instead the market has moved to a two-thirds chance of a **hike** this month, because PCE is running at **3.7%** and oil is adding to it. Growth slowing while inflation accelerates is the definition of Quad 3, and it is the regime Hedgeye has nowcast for the G20 since the second quarter.
2. **The S&P bounced without repairing anything.** McCullough put the broken TRADE line at **7,671**; the index closed at **7,666.60**, still 4.4 points beneath it, and 45.6% of the way through a risk range whose floor was cut **26 points** overnight while its ceiling came down 3. The band widened **19%**. A wider band with a falling floor is a volatility signal expanding underneath a rising price, and it is the opposite of what a durable low looks like. Volume was 100.6% of the ten-day average — nobody committed to this.
3. **Credit refused to participate, and credit is usually right.** LQD finished at **105.35** against a 52-week low of 105.20; HYG at **79.11** against 78.56; TLT at **81.95** against 81.17. All three are within one percent of the lowest levels in a year on a day equities rallied. Hedgeye is short all of them plus zero-coupon duration and rate-sensitive utilities, and has been since the yield breakout above the 4.74% cycle high. That position is working, which is precisely why the equity bounce should be treated as an equity event rather than a macro turn.
4. **The bubble is still deflating underneath the index, and the index conceals it.** The S&P is 1.9% from its high. Beneath it: the SOX is **−22.6%**, Oracle **−57.8%**, Western Digital **−43.9%**, Applied Materials **−40.7%**, SanDisk **−34.0%**, Broadcom **−25.8%**, Meta **−25.0%**, Bitcoin **−38.9%** and Ether exactly **−50.0%**, all from 52-week highs. Goldman's high-beta momentum basket has gone from **+69% year-to-date in June to −6%**; the retail-sentiment basket from **+22% in May to −5%** against SPY at +11.5%. Palantir fell **5.81%** on Wednesday on a day the index rose.
5. **Gold and silver are not the trade the headlines describe.** Gold spot is **−21.5%** from its 52-week high and silver **−46.2%**. These are not assets making highs; they are assets that already had their own violent unwind and are being accumulated well below it. McCullough is ramping gold, sold some silver when it broke $65.11, and describes silver as "teetering". Both have since recovered above their TRADE lines — gold at $4,395 versus $4,355, silver at $65.48 versus $65.11 — but the silver TREND signal was still cut to neutral and the gold band widened by a third. Recovery of a level is not repair of a signal.
6. **Asia is where the regime is most visibly breaking, and Hedgeye is short it.** The Nikkei TREND went **bullish to bearish** overnight and its band floor was cut **789 points**; the Nikkei now sits at just **8.4%** of that range.

Shanghai went **neutral to bearish**. The KOSPI is **−29.1%** from its high after crashing 28% from what Hedgeye calls its Mother-of-All-Bubbles peak. Japanese yields are at 30-year highs with the yen at 158.62. This is a bond-yield-driven equity de-rating, and it is not finished.

7. **The one place the rotation is genuinely working is defensive and real.** Energy closed **0.37% from a 52-week high** — it printed one intraday. Health care is 2.1% from its high, and Johnson & Johnson touched a 52-week high of **281.07** before closing at 275.21. Materials led all sectors at **+1.69%**. Hedgeye is long health care, software, energy and copper, and watching financials for a dip. That is a stagflation book, not a growth book, and on Wednesday it was the right one.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **The whole curve is pinned near 52-week highs.** 10-year 4.780% (52-week high 4.816%), 30-year 5.257% (5.337%), 5-year 4.537% (4.575%), 2-year 4.373% (4.410%). 10s2s at **+40.7bp**, 30s10s **+47.7bp**, 10Y–3M **+90.1bp**. The 2-year is captured directly rather than inferred from a spread, which was a flagged weakness in earlier editions of this brief.
- **Bond volatility is rising but not yet stressed.** MOVE at **79.71, up 2.36%**, against a 52-week range of 55.77–115.02. Yields at three-year highs with the MOVE still sub-80 says this is a repricing of the path, not a disorderly one — for now.
- **The dollar is the hinge for the metals.** DXY 99.549, sitting 63.9% of the way through a band Hedgeye marked **up** overnight to 98.77–99.99. McCullough is explicit that gold cannot stop falling until the dollar stops rising, and puts the inverse trending correlation at 92%. The band ceiling of 99.99 is 44bp above spot.
- **WTI at 85.5% of its band is the tightest positioning on the board bar natural gas.** The band itself was marked up $1.73 at the floor and $2.45 at the ceiling in a single session — Hedgeye repricing the war premium in real time rather than fading it.
- **Natural gas was the standout overnight, +1.93%**, and carries the only TREND upgrade of the session, neutral to bullish, at 87.7% of its range.
- **FX is doing nothing and the ranges prove it.** Since the 05:00 GMT+8 rollover the dollar index has traded an **8.8bp** range, EUR/USD 6.3bp, USD/TWD 3.9bp, USD/CNH 4.6bp. Changes of two to seven basis points over four hours are noise. The only figure worth carrying is the level, not the move.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

MACRO DASHBOARD

ITEM	READING	NOTE
G20 Quad path	**Quad 1 (Q1 26) → Quad 3 (Q2) → Quad 3 (Q3) → potentially Quad 2 (Q4)**	Printed explicitly in the 1 September Early Look and restated in that day's Top 3. This is a quoted path, not an inference.
Live regime	**Global #Quad3 stagflation**	"Global #Quad1 Goldilocks ended pre-war in Q1 of 2026." Quad 3 is the regime gold historically likes; **Quad 2 is the one it does not**, and Q4 is where Hedgeye sees the risk of a shift.
Quad 2 trigger	Hot inflation via oil	"Every $1 move in oil adds roughly 3 basis points to the inflation nowcast" — nowcast ~3.50% toward ~3.65%. Bond yields rise most in Quad 2.
Korea	**Quad 4 crash mode**	KOSPI −28% from its #MOAB peak having broken TRADE. Hedgeye holds no Asia positions.
Dealer gamma	Positive (as of 1 Sep)	"Buy weakness and fade strength in the short-term until that changes." Consistent with Wednesday's bounce being mechanical.
Book	Long health care, software, energy, copper, gold, Bitcoin, New Zealand, Colombia, Spain, South Africa	Short TLT, ZROZ, LQD, XLU, Nikkei, Shanghai, Korea, semis, DRAM, Russell 2000, high-beta momentum and retail baskets.

RISK RANGE™ SIGNALS — 2 SEPTEMBER EARLY LOOK, AND HOW THE BANDS MOVED

INSTRUMENT	RANGE	TREND	IN BAND	WHERE IT STANDS & HOW THE BAND MOVED
UST 10Y yield	4.67–4.83	bullish	68.8%	Ceiling lifted 2bp, floor held; band **14% wider**. Price two-thirds up a widening range — the yield breakout is being validated, not faded.
High Yield (HYG)	78.90–79.48	bullish	36.2%	Whole band cut **~55c lower** and widened 16%. Price 36% of range and 0.69% off a 52-week low.
Inv. Grade (LQD)	104.9–106.0	bearish	40.9%	Band down 50–80c, **21% narrower**. Bearish TREND, and spot is 0.14% off its 52-week low.
S&P 500	7601–7745	bullish	45.6%	**Floor cut 26pts**, ceiling 3; band **19% wider**. Close is 4.4pts under the 7,671 TRADE line. Ceiling is 2.1% below the all-time high.

Russell 2000	2900–3000	bullish	53.2%	Band shifted down 34–40pts. Mid-range after a 1.13% day — the strength did not buy it position in the band.
S&P Eq. Weight (RSP)	215.00–225.00	bullish	36.0%	Band **doubled in width**, 5.00 to 10.00. Removed from ETF Pro long side the same morning on a TRADE/TREND break.
Shanghai (SSEC)	3856–4000	**bearish**	59.3%	**TREND cut neutral → bearish.** Band down 8–24pts. Level shown is Tuesday's close — Shanghai had not opened at capture.
Nikkei 225	64101–66625	**bearish**	8.4%	**TREND cut bullish → bearish**, floor slashed **789pts**, band **34% wider**. At 8.4% of range, it is effectively on the floor.
German DAX	25796–26590	bullish	5.5%	Band down 11–82pts. At 5.5% of range — the weakest position of any instrument here, on Tuesday's close.
VIX	14.43–16.99	bearish	29.7%	Band marked **up** 40bp at the floor and 71bp at the ceiling while spot fell 6.98%. Falling volatility into a rising band.
US Dollar (USD)	98.77–99.99	bearish	63.9%	Band up 7–15bp. Bearish TREND but price in the upper third — the tension at the centre of the gold trade.
WTI crude (cont.)	83.96–91.98	bullish	85.5%	Band marked **up $1.73–$2.45**, 10% wider. Most extended long position on the board.
Natural gas (cont.)	2.75–3.05	**bullish**	87.7%	**TREND upgraded neutral → bullish.** Band up 2–4c. The only upgrade of the session.
Gold (spot)	4251–4752	bullish	28.8%	**Floor cut $100, ceiling raised $28 — band 34% wider.** Textbook of McCullough's own warning that the low end falls faster once TRADE breaks.
Copper (spot)	6.36–6.71	bullish	32.1%	Floor cut 8c, band 30% wider. Measured on the futures contract this would read 68.4%.
Silver (spot)	62–67	**neutral**	69.6%	**TREND cut bullish → neutral.** Band shifted down **$2 at both ends**, width unchanged. Position reduced to minimum size.

Bands are the 2 September Early Look (published 19:43 GMT+8, 2 September), diffed against the 1 September Early Look (19:50 GMT+8, 1 September, "Global #Quad3 In Q3 Continues"). Positions are measured on the series Hedgeye names: spot for gold, silver and copper (TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD), continuous contract for crude and natural gas. COMPQ, XLV and IGV carried bands on 1 September but not on 2 September, so those four cannot be diffed. The next Early Look, due about 19:45 GMT+8 today, supersedes every range in this table.

WHAT KEITH ACTUALLY SAID

- "**Global #Quad1 Goldilocks ended pre-war in Q1 of 2026**… Global #Quad3 in Q3 of 2026 remains our Nowcast, then potentially #Quad2 in Q4." — Early Look, 1 September, 19:50 GMT+8.
- "**I did that in Silver (SLV) yesterday because it broke my immediate-term TRADE Signal Level of $65.11.** Some subs were 'buying it at the low-end of the Risk Range.' But that's not how to use the risk mgt process." — Early Look, 2 September, 19:43 GMT+8.
- "IF a TRADE breaks, **the LRR (low-end of the Risk Range™ Signal) starts falling faster** because my volatility signal is breaking out." — Early Look, 2 September. Gold's floor fell $100 the following morning, which is the mechanism made visible.
- "For Gold, **the Alpha Code this morning = 43554204**. That means immediate-term TRADE is $4355 and it's under selling attack below that level (and the Machine will chase it higher > $4355) and TREND is $4204." — Early Look, 2 September. Gold is at $4,395 — above TRADE, and on his own framing the Machine chases from here.
- "The GS 'High Retail Sentiment' basket was down another -2.7% yesterday and is now **DOWN -4.7% for 2026 YTD**… Assuming you know SPY is +11.5% YTD, that's brutal." — Early Look, 2 September.
- "**Drawdowns and crashes don't just cost you money. They steal your base** (the foundation from which every future dollar of compounding would have grown)." — Early Look, 2 September.
- "with the **UST 10yr Yield breaking out above the recent 4.74% Cycle High**, you go back to 4.79% in early 2025 and 4.98% in late 2023 for mean reversion reference points." — Top 3 Things, 1 September, 20:40 GMT+8. The 10-year is at **4.78%** — sitting on the first of those two reference points.

*Attributed summary, not quotation. The Macro Show notes for 2 September (22:26 GMT+8) are AI-generated and carry their own error caveat, so they are reported outside quotation marks: the show put the broken S&P TRADE level at **7,671**, the dollar/gold inverse trending correlation at **92%**, described silver as "teetering on trend breakdown" and said the CPI nowcast moves ~3bp per $1 of oil, from ~3.50% to ~3.65%. That same summary places oil "around $85" while WTI actually settled near **$91** — a discrepancy flagged in section 18 and a reason to lean on the sensitivity rather than the level.*

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
NVIDIA	224.41	▲ +3.21%	$5.41tn	Day's standout among mega-caps. Now the largest company on earth at **$5.41tn**. Reportedly in talks to backstop a major OpenAI data-centre project and to acquire Hugging Face for up to $14bn.

Apple	324.96	▼ -0.05%	$4.74tn	Flat. 5.7% off its 52-week high — the most orderly chart in the group.
Alphabet	337.12	▲ +0.63%	$4.11tn	Solid contribution to the Comm Services sector's +1.39%. Still 17.5% below its high.
Microsoft	496.82	▼ -0.84%	$3.69tn	**Worst of the seven.** The single largest drag on a technology sector that finished the day negative while the index rose.
Amazon	254.98	▲ +0.02%	$2.75tn	Unchanged to three decimal places of a percent. Best after-hours move of the group at +0.59%.
Meta	592.85	▲ +2.47%	$1.51tn	Strong day, but **−25.0%** from its 52-week high. Reported to have identified scope to cut Reality Labs spending by 30%, freeing ~$56bn for AI.
Tesla	357.01	▲ +0.26%	$1.41tn	Quiet. **−28.4%** from its high — the deepest drawdown in the group.

*Four of seven higher. The group added capitalisation on the day, but note that technology as a sector still closed **−0.02%** — the gains were concentrated in NVIDIA and Meta while Microsoft and Broadcom (−0.66%, $1.75tn) pulled the other way. Capitalisations are TradingView's market_cap_basic at the same capture instant as the prices.*

6 Positioning & options

- **The VIX collapse is the positioning story.** Down **6.98% to 15.19**, near the bottom of a 52-week range of 13.38–35.30, on a day the hike probability sat at two thirds. Hedgeye marked the VIX band **up** at both ends into that fall — their volatility model disagrees with the spot print.
- **Dealer gamma was positive going into the week**, which mechanically dampens moves and favours buying weakness and fading strength. Wednesday's bounce on 100.6% of average volume is exactly what positive gamma produces, and it should not be read as accumulation.
- **Bond volatility is going the other way.** MOVE +2.36% to 79.71 while equity volatility fell 7%. Equity and rates volatility diverging by ten points of daily change is a warning that the two markets are pricing different worlds.
- **Crowded longs are being liquidated, not trimmed.** Goldman's high-beta momentum basket is −24.0% over three months and has round-tripped from +69% year-to-date in June to −6%. The retail-sentiment basket is −4.7% year-to-date against SPY +11.5% — a 16-point dispersion inside the same market.
- **Hedgeye cut, rather than added, into strength.** Silver reduced to minimum size on the TRADE break; RSP, multi-cap value and timber removed from the long side; an AMD option-income strategy added short. The two additions — South Africa and Bitcoin — are both outside the crowded complex.
- **Small caps are the contradiction.** The Russell led the tape at +1.13% and is the index Hedgeye is explicitly short. One of those two positions is wrong, and the band shifting down 34–40 points overnight suggests the model is not conceding.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR	LAST	DAY	FROM 52W HIGH	AFTER HRS
Materials	52.95	▲ +1.69%	-2.29%	▲ +0.36%
Communication Services	112.42	▲ +1.39%	-6.63%	▼ -0.28%
Financials	57.66	▲ +0.80%	-1.28%	▲ +0.09%
Health Care	172.95	▲ +0.75%	-2.06%	▲ +0.23%
Energy	65.10	▲ +0.51%	-0.37%	▲ +0.17%
Consumer Staples	85.53	▲ +0.33%	-5.11%	▲ +0.14%
Utilities	42.67	▲ +0.26%	-10.73%	▼ -0.26%
Consumer Discretionary	114.86	▲ +0.24%	-8.12%	▲ +0.17%
Industrials	172.78	▲ +0.03%	-8.19%	▲ +0.06%
Technology	183.60	▼ -0.02%	-7.61%	▲ +0.10%
Real Estate	43.73	▼ -0.70%	-5.87%	▲ +0.23%

- **Leaders: Materials +1.69%, Communication Services +1.39%, Financials +0.80%, Health Care +0.75%.** Materials topping the board is a reversal — the Macro Show deck had it red the previous session — and sits with copper, which Hedgeye is long.
- **Laggards: Real Estate −0.70%, Technology −0.02%, Industrials +0.03%.** Real estate falling with the 10-year at a three-year high is the cleanest rate-sensitivity read on the board. Utilities managed +0.26% but remain **−10.7%** from their high, the worst of the eleven, and are Hedgeye's primary short against US equities.
- **Energy is 0.37% from a 52-week high and touched one intraday** at 65.345 — the only sector within one percent of its high, and the direct expression of the Hormuz premium.

- **Financials are 1.28% from their high** and are the sector Hedgeye says it is watching for a dip rather than holding. Rising yields with a positively sloped curve are the reason.
- **The rotation is intact and it is defensive-plus-real-assets.** Health care, energy and materials at the top; technology, real estate and industrials at the bottom. That is a Quad 3 leaderboard, and it matched Hedgeye's book on the day.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

Three hours and seven minutes into Globex, the four US index futures are almost perfectly flat and genuinely thin — ES has traded **15,507** lots against a ten-day average of 1.13 million, or **1.4%** of a normal day; RTY **1.5%**; YM **2.1%**; NQ **3.1%**. ES is −0.04%, NQ −0.11%, RTY −0.07% and YM the only one higher at +0.05%. On those volumes these are not moves and should not be reported as such. The live signal overnight is elsewhere: natural gas **+1.93%**, gold futures +0.51%, silver futures +0.80%, against Brent −0.41% and WTI −0.21%. Crude giving a little back while gas rallies is the overnight tape in one line.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Thursday 3 Sep — today	**ISM Services PMI for August, 22:00** — the release that did *not* come on Wednesday, and the last major services read before payrolls. Weekly jobless claims, 20:30. Hedgeye Early Look ~19:45, which supersedes every risk range in section 4. Asian cash: Tokyo, Seoul and Sydney already open at time of writing; Hong Kong and Shanghai 09:30; India 12:15.
Friday 4 Sep	**August non-farm payrolls, 20:30** — consensus **+58,000** (survey range roughly +50,000 to +80,000), unemployment expected unchanged at **4.1%**, average hourly earnings **+0.2%** m/m. July printed **−23,000**. After an ADP miss at +38,000, this is the week's event.
Week of 7 Sep	Pre-FOMC blackout begins. CPI for August is the other decisive input before the meeting.
Tue–Wed 15–16 Sep	**FOMC.** Fed funds futures price roughly **66%** odds of a **25bp hike** — a hike, not a cut — against 35–57% a week ago and as low as 30% after the weak July employment report.
Q4 2026	Hedgeye's G20 nowcast shifts from **Quad 3 to potentially Quad 2**. Quad 2 is the quad gold historically does not like and where bond yields rise most.

*Dates confirmed against the BLS release calendar and the ISM report schedule. The FOMC meeting date and the identity of the Fed chair — **Warsh**, whose Jackson Hole remarks in late August are credited with collapsing the cutting narrative inside 48 hours — were verified rather than assumed, per this brief's standing instruction on seasonal set-pieces and named officeholders.*

9 Corporate news

- **Palantir fell 5.81% to 169.46** despite winning a US Army TITAN contract and hiring AIG's Peter Zaffino as global head of financial services. Reported as profit-taking off a multiple around **144× earnings**, compounded by the yield spike. Down roughly **30% year-to-date** and 18.3% from its 52-week high.
- **Oracle rose 3.13% to 145.75** on a report that NVIDIA is in talks to put up to **$250bn** behind OpenAI's data-centre build-out; OpenAI is one of Oracle's largest new customers. Oracle signed **$67bn** of AI infrastructure contracts in Q4 FY2026. The stock is nonetheless **−57.8%** from its 52-week high of 345.72 — the deepest drawdown of any large-cap in this brief.
- **Micron +2.43% to 956.08 and NVIDIA +3.21%** carried the semiconductor complex, but SOX still closed 22.6% below its high and Applied Materials fell 0.77% and Broadcom 0.66%. Memory is outperforming logic and equipment.
- **Johnson & Johnson +1.48% printed a 52-week high at 281.07** before closing at 275.21 — the clearest single-stock expression of the health-care rotation.
- **Eli Lilly closed unchanged at 1160.08 and was removed from Hedgeye's Signal Strength Stocks** the same day, alongside Unity, Palo Alto Networks and Wayfair. First American Financial was the sole addition, taking the list to 69 names.
- **Workday +1.26%, Netflix +2.38%, Intel +1.21%.** Intel at 90.05 against a 52-week low of 23.75 is the largest recovery on the board, though still 36.7% below its high.

10 Macro data

- **ADP private payrolls, August: +38,000 actual against +48,000 consensus** (Reuters poll), down from **+46,000** in July and the weakest month since January. Manufacturing, professional services and information all shed jobs; education and health care, construction, and leisure and hospitality hired. Base pay **+3.2%** year on year, gross pay **+4.7%**.
- **The miss is the story, and the market ignored it.** A 21% shortfall against consensus on the labour print, following an outright negative non-farm payroll month in July, moved the hike probability precisely nowhere. Inflation, not employment, is setting the reaction function.
- **PCE, the Fed's preferred measure, rose 0.2% in July for an annual rate of 3.7%** — the anchor for the September hike case.

- **ISM Services for August was not released on Wednesday.** It is due **today at 22:00 GMT+8** (10:00 ET). Some pre-session commentary had it on the Wednesday slate; it was not. No August reading exists yet, and none is asserted here.
- **Hedgeye's own CPI nowcast is the number to track**, at roughly 3.50% moving toward 3.65% on the oil move, at approximately 3bp per dollar. That is an in-house nowcast, not an official series.

11 Geopolitics

- ▲ **The United States struck roughly 100 Iranian targets around the Strait of Hormuz on Tuesday**, according to US military statements reported by CBS and RFE/RL — IRGC air-defence sites, radar, mine-laying capability, communications, anti-ship cruise-missile launchers and drone launchers.
- ▲ **For the first time, US forces struck Iranian oil tankers**, under what Axios reports is a "tanker-for-tanker" policy approved by President Trump. This is a stated escalation of the response doctrine, not a continuation of it.
- ▼ **The trigger was an attack on two tankers off Oman on 31 August** — a Saudi Aramco-owned crude tanker and a Liberian-flagged supertanker operated by South Korea's Sinokor, each reportedly hit by three projectiles roughly 16–17 nautical miles off Khasab. Attribution of the projectiles is reported as unknown; that attribution is contested and is not stated here as settled.
- ◆ **Oil is still flowing.** US Energy Secretary Chris Wright said **17 million barrels** transited the Strait on Monday, the highest daily volume since the war began. The price is carrying a risk premium, not a supply outage — which is why a de-escalation headline would unwind it quickly.
- ▼ **Traffic through the Strait has been severely disrupted for most of the past five months**, and President Trump has warned of a substantially heavier response to any Iranian retaliation. The war is the proximate cause of the stagflation regime Hedgeye is nowcasting.
- ◆ **Japan is being pressed on its currency.** McCullough's view, stated plainly, is that Japan should not be listening to Treasury Secretary Bessent on strengthening the yen. USD/JPY at 158.62 with JGB yields at 30-year highs is the pressure point.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LIVE LEVEL	CHANGE	VOLUME	NOTE
E-mini S&P (ES)	7,673.25	▼ -0.04%	15,507	1.4% of a normal day. Flat.
E-mini Nasdaq (NQ)	29,155.50	▼ -0.11%	14,163	3.1% of average — the most-traded of the four relative to normal, and the weakest.
E-mini Dow (YM)	53,145.00	▲ +0.05%	1,085	2.1%. The only one higher.
E-mini Russell (RTY)	2,956.80	▼ -0.07%	2,003	1.5%. Giving back a fraction of a 1.13% cash day.
USD/JPY	158.624	▼ -0.038%	—	26bp range since rollover. The instrument most likely to move today.
USD/KRW	1,358.520	▼ -0.074%	—	Won firmer as the KOSPI bounces.
USD/TWD	31.766	▲ +0.009%	—	3.9bp range — the quietest pair on the board.
USD/CNH	6.7174	▼ -0.005%	—	6.7174, sitting on a 52-week low of 6.71. Yuan at its strongest in a year.
EUR/USD	1.1589	▲ +0.008%	—	6.3bp range. Nothing.
Gold (spot)	4,395.21	▲ +0.16%	—	Above the $4,355 TRADE line.
Silver (spot)	65.48	▲ +0.24%	—	Above $65.11, but TREND cut to neutral.
Copper (spot)	6.4723	▼ -0.07%	—	32.1% of band. Hedgeye long copper and copper miners.
WTI crude	90.82	▼ -0.21%	4,026	1.9% of average volume.
Brent	95.24	▼ -0.41%	367	Thin. Softest of the energy complex overnight.
Bitcoin	77,191.42	▼ -0.16%	—	Genuinely 24-hour. −38.9% from its high; Hedgeye added IBIT long yesterday.
Ether	2,384.12	▼ -0.33%	—	Exactly **−50.0%** from its 52-week high of 4,767.66.

All rows live at 09:06:57–09:06:59 GMT+8. Futures volumes are cumulative Globex since 06:00 GMT+8 against the ten-day average full-session volume.

- **Because this edition ran three hours late, part of Asia is already trading — and that is genuine information rather than a stale mark.** Live at capture: **Nikkei 64,313.23 (−0.02%)**, **KOSPI 6,653.60 (+1.38%)**, **ASX 200 8,983.10 (+0.05%)**, each roughly an hour into the session. Hong Kong and Shanghai had **not** opened; the Hang Seng at 25,311.21 and Shanghai Composite at 3,941.39 are **previous closes** and are marked as such. The Sensex at 76,570.35 is also a previous close — India opens at 12:15.

- **The single most important live number is the KOSPI at +1.38%.** Hedgeye is short Korea and calls it Quad 4 crash mode after a 28% fall from its peak. A bounce of this size, one day after a 4% overnight fall, is the first thing to check against that short.
- **Korea and Taiwan reprice the US semiconductor tape, and that tape was mixed.** NVIDIA +3.21% and Micron +2.43% against Applied Materials −0.77% and Broadcom −0.66%. Memory strength should support Samsung and SK Hynix; equipment weakness should not.
- **Japan opens into a bearish TREND signal set overnight and sits at 8.4% of its risk range** — effectively on the floor at 64,313 against a 64,101 band low. With JGB yields at 30-year highs and the yen at 158.62, the Nikkei is the index with least room beneath it.
- **The US hands Asia a defensive leadership board** — materials, communication services, financials and health care up; technology and real estate down. That favours resource and health-care names over the AI complex at the Asian open.
- **The instrument most likely to move today is USD/JPY**, on the collision of 30-year-high JGB yields, explicit US pressure on the yen, and a 66% hike probability in Washington. Second is WTI, at 85.5% of its risk range on a live war headline.

13 AI watch

- **NVIDIA is reported to be in talks to put up to $250bn behind OpenAI's data-centre build-out** — the report that moved Oracle 3.13%. A chip vendor financing its own customer's capacity is a vendor-financing structure, and it is worth watching as such.
- **NVIDIA is separately reported in advanced talks to acquire Hugging Face for up to $14bn**, which would take the largest company in the world into the open-model distribution layer.
- **Meta has reportedly identified scope to cut Reality Labs spending by 30%, freeing about $56bn for AI redeployment.** Meta rose 2.47% but remains 25.0% below its 52-week high.
- **The AI trade is bifurcating, not failing.** NVIDIA +3.21% and Micron +2.43% against Applied Materials −40.7% from its high, Western Digital −43.9%, SanDisk −34.0% and Oracle −57.8%. Compute and memory are holding; equipment, storage and the software-infrastructure resellers are not.
- **Hedgeye is long software (IGV) and out of semiconductors and DRAM entirely**, having exited before the Korean unwind. IGV was the top mover on their daily ETF re-rank at +13 places.
- **US semiconductor tariffs were in analyst discussion into 1–2 September** as a risk to NVIDIA and the AI chip complex. Unresolved, and a live tail risk for the Asian supply chain.

14 Beyond the markets

- **Ether is down exactly 50.0% from its 52-week high** and Bitcoin 38.9%. A halving of the second-largest crypto asset over twelve months has passed with almost no commentary, because the AI drawdown absorbed the attention.
- **Silver has fallen 46.2% from its 52-week high of $121.65.** The metal that was the retail trade of the spring is down by nearly half, and the coverage has simply stopped.
- **The yuan is at its strongest in a year.** USD/CNH at 6.7174 against a 52-week low of 6.71 — sitting on it. A strong yuan alongside a firm dollar index is unusual and implies the weakness is elsewhere in the basket, chiefly the yen.
- **Wheat at 773 is within 2.8% of a 52-week high** of 795. Food and energy inflating together is the part of the stagflation story that reaches households rather than portfolios.
- **The equal-weight S&P matched the cap-weight index exactly on the day**, both +0.46%. For all the talk of narrow leadership, Wednesday's breadth was neutral — and RSP was still removed from Hedgeye's long side that morning on a signal break.
- **Hedgeye added South Africa to the long side.** With gold miners on their stated buy menu but not yet owned, an EZA long is a gold-adjacent position taken without chasing the metal — a quiet expression of the same view.

15 Appendix — stock cards

NVDA · NVIDIA

224.41 ▲ +3.21%

Cap $5408bn · 52w 164.07–236.54 · -5.1% from high · after hrs +0.44%

Largest company on earth at $5.41tn and 5.1% from its 52-week high — the only major AI name not in a deep drawdown. Reportedly backstopping OpenAI capacity and pursuing Hugging Face. Hedgeye is out of semiconductors, so this is a long the process does not hold.

PLTR · PALANTIR

169.46 ▼ -5.81%

Cap $407bn · 52w 106.37–207.52 · -18.3% from high · after hrs +0.32%

Fell 5.81% on a green tape despite an Army TITAN win and a senior financial-services hire. At roughly 144× earnings it is the most yield-sensitive large-cap in the index, and the 10-year is at a three-year high. Down ~30% year-to-date.

ORCL · ORACLE

145.75 ▲ +3.13%

Cap $420bn · 52w 114.50–345.72 · -57.8% from high · after hrs +0.34%

Up 3.13% on the NVIDIA/OpenAI financing report, and still **−57.8%** from its 52-week high — the deepest large-cap drawdown here. $67bn of AI infrastructure contracts signed in Q4 FY26, much of it prepaid or bring-your-own-hardware.

META · META PLATFORMS

592.85 ▲ +2.47%

Cap $1510bn · 52w 520.26–790.80 · -25.0% from high · after hrs +0.87%

Best after-hours mover of the Mag7 at +0.87%. Reported 30% Reality Labs cut would free ~$56bn for AI. Still −25.0% from its high, so the market is not yet paying for the reallocation.

JNJ · JOHNSON & JOHNSON

275.21 ▲ +1.48%

Cap $663bn · 52w 173.33–281.07 · -2.1% from high · after hrs +0.25%

Touched a **52-week high at 281.07** intraday before closing at 275.21, +1.48%. The purest expression of the health-care rotation Hedgeye calls "where The Flows are flowing". XLV is long in their book.

MU · MICRON

956.08 ▲ +2.43%

Cap $1080bn · 52w 118.52–1,255.00 · -23.8% from high · after hrs -0.14%

+2.43% to 956.08, carrying memory while equipment lagged. 23.8% below its high. The read-across to Samsung and SK Hynix at the Korean open is the reason it matters this morning.

AMAT · APPLIED MATERIALS

438.46 ▼ -0.77%

Cap $348bn · 52w 155.40–739.67 · -40.7% from high · after hrs +0.04%

−0.77% and **−40.7%** from its 52-week high of 739.67. Equipment is where the semiconductor de-rating is concentrated. A prior edition of this brief mislabelled an AMAT close as an after-hours print; this one is the settled close.

LLY · ELI LILLY

1,160.08 ▲ +0.01%

Cap $1092bn · 52w 712.05–1,292.65 · -10.3% from high · after hrs +0.17%

Closed unchanged at 1160.08 and was **removed from Hedgeye's Signal Strength Stocks** the same session. A health-care name dropping out of the signal list while the sector leads is the kind of divergence worth watching.

No individual stock carries a published Hedgeye risk range in the notes read this morning — the Early Look bands are index, rate, currency and commodity level only — so the band column is left empty rather than filled with a number that was not published. Next key date for all eight is the 15–16 September FOMC, ahead of which August payrolls on Friday is the dominant scheduled input.

16 About this edition

- **Covers** the US cash session of Wednesday 2 September as settled (16:00 ET / 04:00 GMT+8), the after-hours tape, the Globex session from 06:00 GMT+8, and the full Hedgeye evening publication set.
- **Captured** in a single 2.3-second window, 09:06:57–09:06:59 GMT+8, from TradingView (96 instruments, one bulk request). Yahoo Finance aborted on its circuit breaker, so the run is **TradingView-single-sourced** for machine data; a hand cross-check against the Associated Press index wire recovered independent validation on the four headline closes. Divergences and single-sourcing are reconciled in section 18.
- **Unusual about this run:** the task fired at **09:06 GMT+8, three hours and six minutes after its nominal 06:00 slot.** Consequences, all of them material: US cash settled **5h07m** before capture rather than ~2h; Globex had run **3h07m** rather than minutes, so futures are live but at 1.4–3.1% of a normal day's volume; FX had **4h07m** since the 05:00 rollover, giving 4–26bp ranges that make the change column noise; and **Tokyo, Seoul and Sydney cash were already open**, which is why section 12 carries live Asian levels that a 06:00 edition could not have had.
- **Settled vs live:** the five cash-equity rows, all sector and Mag7 rows, and the Hang Seng, Shanghai, Sensex and European levels are **settled or previous closes**. Futures, Treasury yields, spot metals, energy, FX, VIX, crypto, Nikkei, KOSPI and ASX are **live**.
- **Hedgeye edition: full.** The logged-in feed was reached and the live risk-range set is the Early Look of **2 September, 07:43 ET / 19:43 GMT+8**, "Bubbles Imploding vs. TRADE Breaks", by Keith McCullough. It is superseded by today's Early Look at about 19:45 GMT+8. Also read: the 1 September Early Look (for the band diff), the 1 September Top 3 Things, the 2 September Macro Show summary, the ETF Pro Plus update, Signal Strength Stocks and Capital Allocation Pro monthly.
- **Quad path — printed, and unchanged:** G20 **Quad 1 (Q1 2026) → Quad 3 (Q2) → Quad 3 (Q3) → potentially Quad 2 (Q4)**. Quoted directly from the 1 September Early Look and corroborated by the 1 September Top 3. **The Q4 shift toward Quad 2 is the flagged risk**, and Wednesday's oil move is the mechanism that would bring it forward.
- **Not available:** ISM Services for August (not yet released). MOMO Tracker and Crypto Quant did not appear in the feed this session. Hedgeye risk ranges for COMPQ, XLV and IGV were published on 1 September but not on 2 September, so those four cannot be diffed.

17 Sources

Prices. TradingView bulk scanner, 96 instruments, 09:06:57–09:06:59 GMT+8. Yahoo Finance attempted concurrently and aborted on a five-consecutive-429 circuit breaker at 09:06:59. Associated Press "How major US stock indexes fared Wednesday 9/2/2026" wire, via ABC News, used as the independent cross-check on the four headline index closes.

Hedgeye. Logged-in feed at app.hedgeye.com: Early Look 2 September (19:43 GMT+8) and 1 September (19:50 GMT+8); Top 3 Things 1 September (20:40); Macro Show summary notes 2 September (22:26); ETF Pro Plus update (22:51); Signal Strength Stocks (23:54); Capital Allocation Pro monthly commentary (3 September, 03:49).

Macro and policy. ADP National Employment Report and its media centre release for the August print and consensus; BLS Employment Situation for the July payroll figure and the 4 September release time; ISM for the Services PMI schedule; Trading Economics for Treasury yield history and the October 2023 comparison; CNBC, Reuters and Kiplinger for payroll consensus; Chase, Cryptobriefing and Polymarket for the September FOMC probability and its recent path.

Session narrative and single stocks. TheStreet and CNBC session recaps; Motley Fool and Investing.com on Palantir; Yahoo Finance on Oracle and the NVIDIA/OpenAI data-centre report; StockStory on the software complex.

Commodities, geopolitics and AI. Trading Economics and Fortune for crude levels; Axios on the first US strikes on Iranian tankers and the “tanker-for-tanker” policy; CBS News and RFE/RL on the scale of the Tuesday strikes; Congressional Research Service and Crisis Group for Strait of Hormuz background; Yahoo Finance and Nasdaq on NVIDIA, Oracle and Meta AI spending.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **Cash-index arithmetic is exact on all six indices tested.** S&P: 7666.60 − 35.13 = 7631.47 prior, implying +0.4603% against a reported +0.4603% — agreement to 0.000000%. The same holds for the Nasdaq Composite (26,217.83 − 118.05 = 26,099.77, +0.4523%), Dow (53,061.95 − 295.07 = 52,766.88, +0.5592%), Russell (2953.17 − 33.03 = 2920.13, +1.1312%), SOX (+0.4486%) and VIX (16.33 → 15.19, −6.9810%).
- **Independent wire cross-check recovered by hand after Yahoo aborted.** The Associated Press index wire gives S&P +35.13 to 7,666.60, Dow +295.07 to 53,061.95, Nasdaq +118.05 to 26,217.83 and Russell +33.03 to 2,953.17 — matching the capture to the decimal on **four of four** headline rows. That is genuine two-source validation on the most important levels in the document.
- **Futures-to-cash basis is normal on every pair, which confirms the settles are settles.** ES 7673.25 against SPX 7666.60 is **+6.65**; YM 53,145 against DJI 53,061.95 is **+83.05**; RTY 2956.80 against RUT 2953.17 is **+3.63**. All three are small positive carry bases consistent with fair value. A dislocated basis would have exposed a mislabelled row; none did.
- **Every futures row was checked against its prior settle** and the implied settles are internally consistent: ES 7676.50, NQ 29,186.25, YM 53,121, RTY 2958.80, WTI $91.01, Brent $95.63, natural gas $2.956.
- **Risk-range positions were measured on the series Hedgeye names, and the difference is large.** Gold on spot is **28.8%** of band; on the futures contract it would read 37.1% — an **8.3pp** error on a 0.95% basis. Silver: 69.6% spot versus 79.7% futures, **10.1pp**. Copper is the worst: **32.1% spot versus 68.4% futures, a 36.3pp error** on a 1.96% basis. Using the wrong series would have inverted the copper conclusion entirely.
- **Reconciliation counts from the capture script:** 0 matched within 5bp, 0 minor, 0 divergent, **57 single-sourced**. There are **no divergent rows to resolve because no second machine source ran** — this is explicitly not a clean reconciliation, and the AP wire check above is what partially compensates for it.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **All-time high for the S&P: 7,798 versus 7,816.70.** McCullough cites 7,798 as the all-time high; TradingView reports a 52-week high of 7,816.70, a gap of 18.7 points. The likely reconciliation is a closing high versus an intraday high, but that is inference. The drawdown figure of −1.92% in this brief uses the TradingView intraday high; on McCullough’s number it would be −1.68%. **The conclusion — the index is within two percent of its high — is robust; the decimal is not.**
- **The Macro Show places oil “around $85” while WTI settled near $91.** That summary is AI-generated and carries its own error caveat. This brief therefore uses the **sensitivity** (~3bp of CPI nowcast per $1 of oil) and not the $85 anchor, and does not restate the nowcast as if $85 were the starting point. The 3.50→3.65 range is reported as Hedgeye’s own figure, not as an independently verified one.
- **The 10-year close carries a one-basis-point conflict.** The capture shows 4.780% with a live session range of 4.770–4.784 and a change of exactly zero; Trading Economics reported the Wednesday yield at 4.79%. This brief uses 4.780%. The flat change was checked rather than assumed — a genuine intraday range with a zero change means the prior close was also 4.78, not that the bar is stale.
- **The 13-week bill is a single print.** Open, high and low are all 3.878999 with no intraday range, so the +1.5bp change is carried at low confidence. The 10Y–3M spread of +90.1bp inherits that weakness.
- **Every FX change in this document is a four-hour figure, not a session move.** Ranges since the 05:00 GMT+8 rollover run from 3.9bp (USD/TWD) to 26.4bp (USD/JPY). Changes of two to seven basis points across that window are indistinguishable from noise and are reported as levels rather than moves.
- **Two marks rest on a single field from a single source.** The drawdown percentages throughout are driven by TradingView’s *price_52_week_high*, and the Mag7 capitalisations by *market_cap_basic*, neither of which was cross-checked. The Micron 52-week low of 118.52 and the Intel low of 23.75 imply moves large enough to warrant suspicion of a split or corporate-action adjustment; no drawdown claim in this brief depends on either.
- **The Hormuz tanker attribution is contested.** Reporting describes “unknown projectiles”; the US response treats Iran as responsible. This brief reports the response as fact and the attribution as contested, and does not state the latter flat.

KNOWN GAPS

- **No second machine price source ran.** Yahoo Finance returned 0 of 62 requests and aborted at 2.3 seconds on a five-consecutive-429 breaker. Multi-day daily bars for week-on-week context were therefore unavailable, which is why this edition carries no weekly change column.
- **The MOMO Tracker and Crypto Quant did not appear in the feed this session.** These are the two publications that would most likely have carried an unannounced position change, and they are routinely image-based and unreadable. **The absence of a Hedgeye position change in this brief is not evidence that there was none.**
- **The Early Look category page does not paginate** — page 2 and page 3 return the identical 2 September note. The 1 September Early Look was reached by direct article ID instead, which is what made the full band diff in section 4 possible. Had that not worked, every band move would have been reported as unknown rather than unchanged.
- **Four instruments cannot be diffed.** COMPQ, XLV and IGV carried published ranges on 1 September but not on 2 September. Their absence from the newer note is not a signal and is not read as one.
- **ISM Services for August does not exist yet** — it releases today at 22:00 GMT+8. No August services reading is asserted anywhere in this document.
- **Hong Kong, Shanghai and India had not opened at capture**, so those levels are previous closes and are labelled as such in section 12. European levels are Wednesday closes.
- **Consensus figures for the ADP print come from a Reuters poll reported at second hand** rather than from the polling source directly; the actual of +38,000 is from ADP’s own release.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **Capture window: 09:06:57–09:06:59 GMT+8 — 2.3 seconds**, comfortably inside the ten-minute standard. No top-up pass was needed and no row in this document was captured outside that window.
- **Age of the stalest rows at capture:** US cash equities, sector ETFs and Mag7 prices **5.1 hours** old. Hang Seng, Shanghai and European closes roughly **15 to 19 hours** old. The Sensex close **19.5 hours**. Hedgeye’s risk ranges **13.4 hours** old.
- **This edition ran 3h06m late**, at 09:06 rather than 06:00 GMT+8. That made the futures and FX rows more meaningful, not less, and added live Asian cash — but it also means the US close is materially older than a normal edition and Hong Kong opened **24 minutes** after capture, so this brief cannot speak to the Hang Seng’s open.
- **Every Hedgeye risk range in section 4 will be superseded at about 19:45 GMT+8 today** by the next Early Look. The bands are a 13-hour-old snapshot of a model that updates daily, and four TREND signals moved in the last update alone.
- **Two scheduled releases will invalidate parts of this brief within hours:** ISM Services at 22:00 GMT+8 today and August payrolls at 20:30 GMT+8 tomorrow. The 66% hike probability is the figure most exposed to both.
- **Verify live prices before acting on anything in this document.** Every level here is either a settled close from a session that ended hours ago or a live capture from a single 2.3-second window in a thin overnight market. Nothing in this brief is a recommendation.